

FREE GUIDE · FALL 2026 · 20 SPOTS

MIDLANDS WEEKEND GAME PLAN

Where to go, what it costs and how to get there. Tap any button and your phone takes you straight there.



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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

THE LINEUP

Tap any name to jump to it. On every page, **Map** opens Google Maps with directions and the other buttons go to tickets, deals or the official site. **Back to the lineup** at the bottom of each page brings you here.

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Deals, prices and hours were checked on each venue's own website on Oct 15, 2026. They change. Tap the link and confirm before you go.



FAMILY AND KIDS

01 SC STATE FAIR

Eleven days of rides, fair food, livestock and lights. The 2026 fair runs **Oct 15 to 25** on Rosewood Drive, right next to Williams-Brice. Go after dark when the midway lights up.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- Gates: Fri 11 AM, Sat 10 AM, Sun noon. Close 9 PM (8 PM Oct 25).
- Fri and Sat: under 18 must be with a parent (21+) all day. Sun to Thu: after 5 PM.

DEALS

- Kids 5 and under: free every day
- Admission: $15 at Circle K or $16 online during the fair. $20 at the gate.
- Seniors 55+: $15 daily, $5 on Senior Day (Wed Oct 21)
- Lunch Bunch (weekdays noon to 2): get your $20 back if you leave by 2 PM
- Unlimited ride voucher: $40 at Circle K, $42 at the gate Fri to Sun

Map | Buy tickets | Fair calendar



FAMILY AND KIDS

02 RIVERBANKS ZOO AND GARDEN

One of the best zoos in the Southeast, plus a botanical garden across the river. Giraffe feeding, sea lions, the skyway and rides. In October it turns into **Boo at the Zoo**.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 500 Wildlife Pkwy, Columbia
- Open daily 9 AM to 5 PM
- Under 2: free

DEALS AND EVENTS

- Buy online and save $3 per ticket: adults $27.95, kids 2 to 12 $24.95
- Parking: $3 online, $6 at the gate
- Boo at the Zoo: Oct 16 to 30, 6 to 9 PM. Trick-or-treat through the zoo, DJ dance party and more.

Map | Zoo tickets | Boo at the Zoo



FAMILY AND KIDS

03 CLINTON SEASE FARM

Lexington's fall tradition. Corn maze, pumpkin patch, wagon rides and a big playground on a working family farm. Stay after dark and do the maze by flashlight.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 382 Olde Farm Rd, Lexington
- Open Sept 25 to Nov 8, 2026
- Fri 6 to 10 PM, Sat 10 AM to 10 PM, Sun 2 to 7 PM
- No coolers, outside food or pets

WHAT YOU GET

- $20 per person (ages 3+). 2 and under free.
- Includes every maze, the playground, obstacle course, unlimited wagon rides and the pumpkin patch (pumpkins sold separately)
- Bring a flashlight for night mazes, or buy one there for $5
- Kettle corn, cider slushies, soft serve and food trucks on site

Map | Buy tickets | Farm website



FAMILY AND KIDS

04 EDVENTURE CHILDREN'S MUSEUM

Hands-on science and play built for kids. Climb, build, experiment and wear them out before nap time. Great rainy day call.

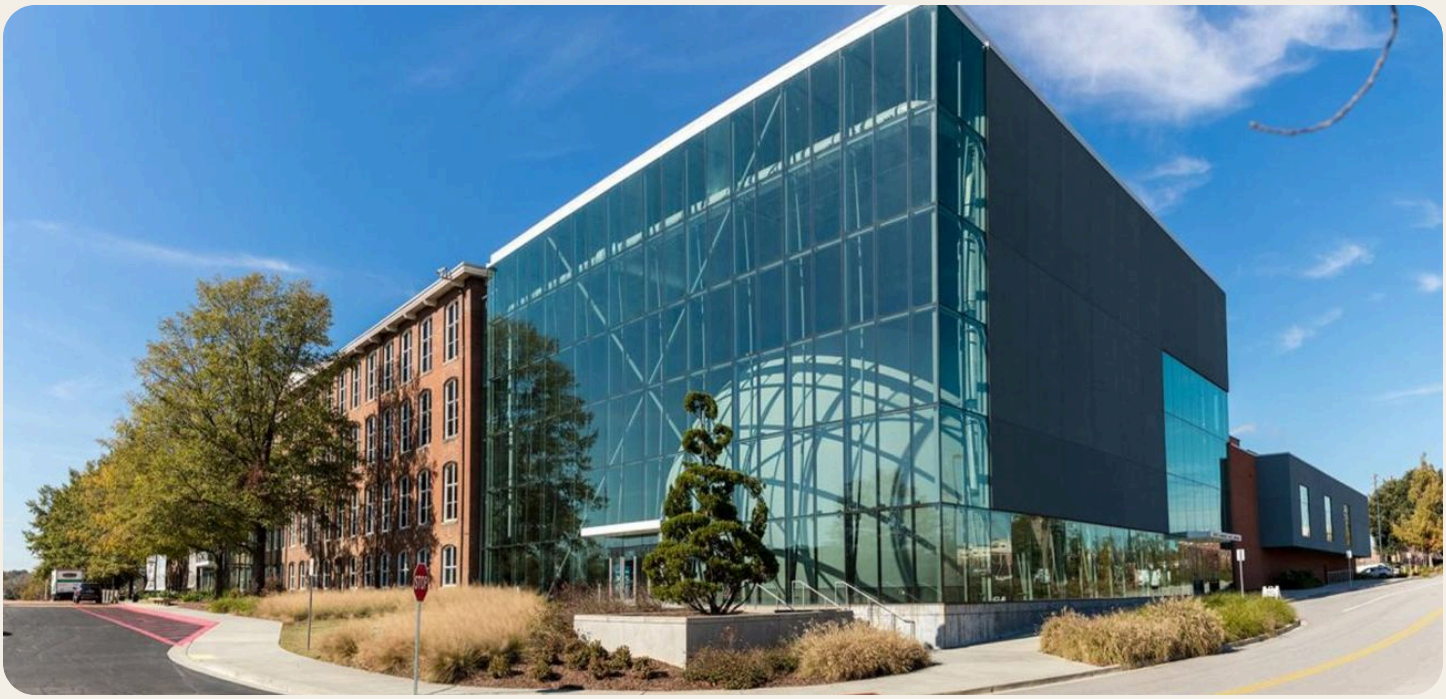
KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 211 Gervais St, Columbia (next to the State Museum)
- Open 9 AM to 5 PM. Sun noon to 5 PM.
- **Closed Tuesday**

DEALS

- $15 for kids and adults
- $10 for military, first responders and seniors with ID
- Under 2: free

Map | Plan your visit



FAMILY AND KIDS

05 SC STATE MUSEUM

Four floors of South Carolina: fossils, science, history and art. Add the planetarium or the 4D theater and make it a full afternoon.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 301 Gervais St, Columbia
- Tue to Sat 10 AM to 5 PM. Sun noon to 5 PM.
- **Closed Monday**

DEALS

- Adults $13. Seniors 62+ $11.
- **First Sunday of every month: $1 general admission**
- Planetarium and 4D shows are extra

Map | Hours and tickets | First Sunday



FAMILY AND KIDS

06 STARS AND STRIKES, IRMO

Bowling, a 7,500-square-foot arcade, a multi-story laser tag arena and VR, all on Lake Murray Boulevard. An easy win when the weather doesn't cooperate.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 800 Lake Murray Blvd, Irmo
- Sat: 10 AM to 1 AM
- Sun: 10 AM to midnight

DEALS

- 5th Quarter: wear your team jersey or uniform on an October Saturday, get a FREE 1-hour Unlimited Game Card
- Sunday morning: $1.99 bowling, plus half-price arcade, laser tag and VR
- Sunday 6 PM to close: half-price bowling, arcade, laser tag and VR
- Late Night Saturday: unlimited play, 10 PM to close

Map | Irmo specials



FAMILY AND KIDS

07 DAVE & BUSTER'S

A big arcade, sports on every screen and a full kitchen under one roof at Columbiana. Kids play, adults watch the game.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 100 Columbiana Circle, Columbia (Harbison area)
- Sat and Sun: open at 10 AM
- Fri and Sat: open until 1 AM

DEALS

- Game Day Deals (Sun, Mon, Thu): 10 wings for $10, $5 drink specials
- Happy Hour Mon to Fri, 4:30 to 7 PM: drinks from $5
- Eat & Play Combo from $19.99: entrée plus a $10 Power Card

Map | Specials



FAMILY AND KIDS

08 TRAMPOLINE PARKS

Burn off a whole week of energy. Two big indoor parks on the Lexington and Irmo side. Trampolines, foam pits, dodgeball, ninja courses and climbing walls. Grip socks required at both.

BIG AIR, LEXINGTON

- 934 N Lake Dr, Lexington
- Mega Jump (Mon and Wed): 3 hours for $23, all day for $26
- Twofer Tuesday: 2 hours for $20
- Toddler Time: Tue and Thu, 10 AM to 1 PM
- Cosmic Night: Fri and Sat nights

FLIGHT ADVENTURE PARK, IRMO

- 1019 Broad Stone Rd, Irmo
- Open 9 AM daily. Until 10 PM Fri and Sat.
- Trampolines, climbing and ninja courses
- Note: Flight's Sandhill location is listed as closed. Go to Irmo.

Map: Big Air | Big Air deals | Map: Flight | Flight tickets



FOOD AND SWEETS

09 SODA CITY MARKET ON MAIN

Every Saturday, four blocks of Main Street close to cars and fill with local food, farmers, makers and music, one block from the State House. Rain or shine, all year.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 1300 to 1700 blocks of Main St, Columbia
- Every Saturday, 9 AM to 1 PM
- Free to walk. Bring cash and cards.
- Go early for the best food lines

MAKE IT A MORNING

- Breakfast from a food stall
- Walk up to the State House steps
- Stay on Main for lunch at The Grand (next page)

Map | Soda City website



FOOD AND SWEETS

10 THE GRAND ON MAIN

A boutique bowling alley, restaurant and bar in the 1600 block of Main Street. American comfort food, live music and Urban Tiki on the lower level. Date night or group night.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 1621 Main St, Columbia
- Open for lunch, dinner and weekend brunch
- Fri and Sat: open until 2 AM
- Book a lane ahead on weekends

ORDER THIS

- Brunch after Soda City on Saturday
- A round of bowling before dinner
- Drinks downstairs at Urban Tiki

Map | Menu | Book a lane



FOOD AND SWEETS

11 KRISPY KREME, HOT LIGHT ON

When the red Hot Light is on, Original Glazed doughnuts are coming off the line right now. Warm, soft, gone in two bites. Pick the shop closest to you.

THREE SHOPS

- Cayce: 1200 Knox Abbott Dr
- Garners Ferry: 6614 Garners Ferry Rd
- Northeast: 110 Clemson Rd
- Open 6 AM daily. Until 11 PM Fri and Sat.

DEALS

- Join Krispy Kreme Rewards: free doughnut with any purchase
- The app shows when the Hot Light is on
- Autumn Collection through Nov 2: Pumpkin Spice, Biscoff Cookie Butter, Maple Cheesecake

Map: Cayce | Map: Garners Ferry | Map: Northeast | Rewards



FOOD AND SWEETS

12 ZESTO OF WEST COLUMBIA

A West Columbia staple since 1949. Look for the giant chocolate-dipped cone out front on 12th Street. Fried chicken, burgers, dogs, milkshakes and soft serve, done the old-school way.

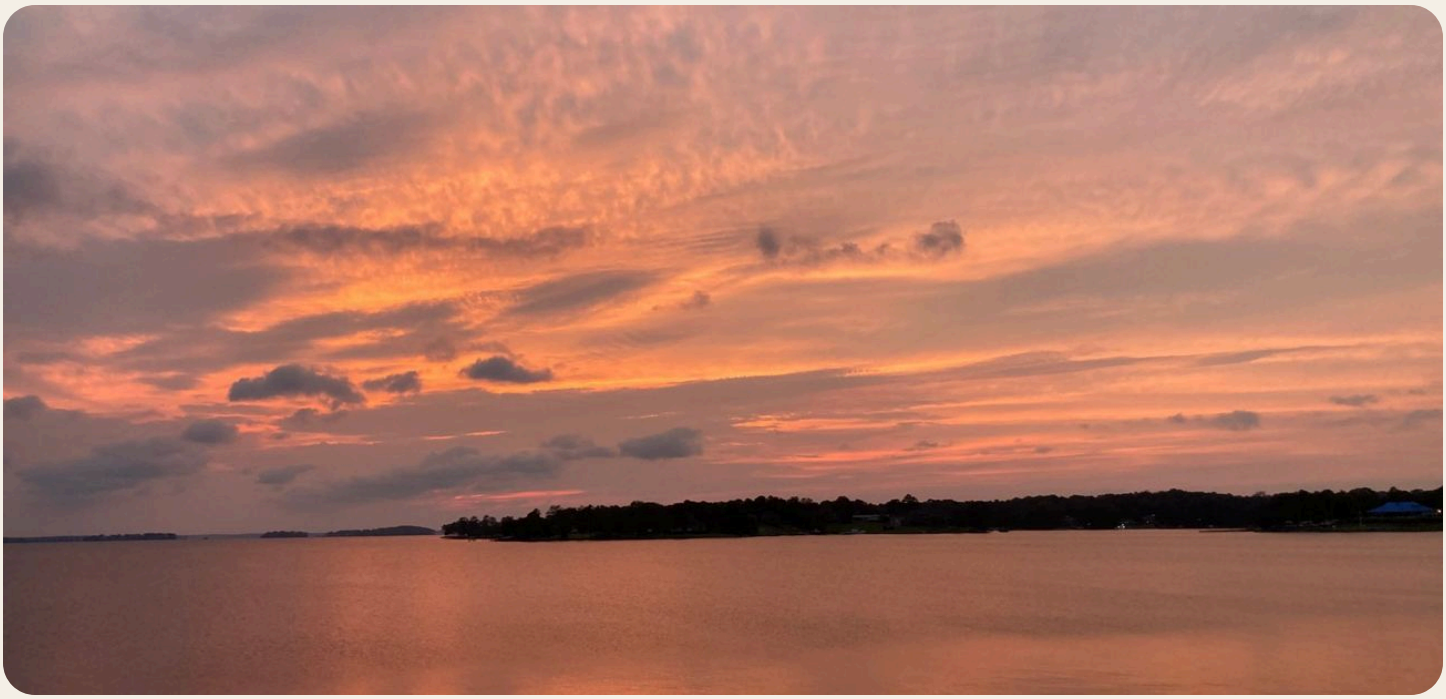
KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 504 12th St, West Columbia
- Mon to Sat: 10 AM to 10 PM
- **Closed Sunday.** Make it a Friday night or Saturday stop.

ORDER THIS

- The fried chicken it's known for
- A chocolate-dipped cone
- A hand-blended milkshake

Map | Website and menu



OUTDOORS

13 LAKE MURRAY DAM WALK

A 1.7-mile walkway across the Lake Murray dam, connecting the Irmo and Lexington sides of Lake Murray Public Park. Lake on one side, sky on the other. The sunset walk is the move.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- Park at the Dreher Shoals Dam lot, 1836 N Lake Dr, Lexington
- 1.7 miles one way. 3.4 round trip.
- Bring water. There is little shade on the dam.

MAKE IT A PLAN

- Walk out at golden hour
- Turn around at the far end
- Dinner in Lexington or Irmo after

Map: parking | Lake Murray Public Park



OUTDOORS

14 WEST COLUMBIA RIVERWALK

Riverfront on the West Columbia side of the Congaree, right next to the Gervais Street Bridge. Shaded paved path, picnic tables and river views. Keep going about 2.5 miles to old Cayce.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- Meeting St and Alexander Rd, West Columbia
- Open sunrise to 3 hours after sunset
- Free. Restrooms and water at the main entrance.

MAKE IT A PLAN

- Walk or run it in the morning
- Pack a picnic for the tables by the water
- Come back for sunset on the river

Map | City park page



OUTDOORS

15 SALUDA RIVERWALK

Paved path and elevated boardwalk along the Saluda River, mostly shaded, with benches, river access and plenty of wildlife. Locals call it one of the best walks in town.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 650 Candi Ln, Columbia (off Hwy 378 near I-126)
- Open 6 AM to 9 PM
- Free. Lot fills up on nice weekends.

MAKE IT A PLAN

- Bring the dog on a leash
- Walk the boardwalk over the river
- Pair it with Riverbanks Zoo next door

Map



OUTDOORS

16 SALUDA SHOALS PARK

A 480-acre riverfront park on the Saluda River between Irmo and Lexington. About ten miles of trails, a river observation deck, disc golf, a big playground, picnic shelters and kayak and tube rentals in season. In winter it hosts Holiday Lights on the River.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- West entrance: 5605 Bush River Rd, Columbia
- Fall hours: 7 AM to 7 PM through Oct 31. 7 AM to 5 PM in Nov and Dec.
- Parking: $7 per car per day

DEALS

- 1-month park pass: $10 per vehicle
- Annual parking pass: $75
- Coming up: Holiday Lights on the River this winter. Tickets on the park site.

Map | Park info | Holiday Lights



OUTDOORS

17 DOWNTOWN LEXINGTON

Lexington's front yard. Virginia Hylton Park has a big playground, shaded paved trail, swinging benches and little ponds. Icehouse Amphitheater sits right across the way and hosts free concerts and holiday events.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- Virginia Hylton Park: 111 Maiden Ln, open 7 AM to 9 PM
- Icehouse Amphitheater: 107 W Main St
- Restaurants on Main Street within walking distance

EVENTS

- The free Thursday fall concert series ran Aug 27 to Oct 8 this year. Mark it for next fall.
- Watch the Icehouse events page for holiday shows and community events

Map: park | Map: Icehouse | Icehouse events



OUT ON THE TOWN

18 CRAFT AXE THROWING

Real axes, real targets, in the Vista. A coach walks you through it, then it's you against your friends. Great for date night, a birthday or a group outing.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 700 Gervais St, Columbia (the Vista)
- Tue to Thu 4 to 9 PM, Fri 3 to 11 PM, Sat noon to 11 PM, Sun 2 to 7 PM
- **Closed Monday**
- Ages 10 and up

COST

- Plan on about $25 per person for an hour. It varies by session.
- Groups of about 10 or more get event pricing
- Drinks available on site for adults

Map | Book a lane



OUT ON THE TOWN

19 THE VILLAGE AT SANDHILL

Northeast Columbia's open-air town center. Shops, restaurants and a movie theater laid out around walkable streets and a big fountain.

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

- 481 Town Center Place, Columbia (Northeast)
- Mon to Sat: 10 AM to 9 PM
- Sun: noon to 6 PM

MAKE IT A PLAN

- Shop in the afternoon
- Dinner on site
- Catch a movie after

Map | Website | Promotions



GAME DAY

20 GAME DAY AT WILLIAMS-BRICE

Home of the South Carolina Gamecocks. It opened in 1934 as Carolina Stadium with 17,600 seats, built by the Works Progress Administration. In 1972 it was renamed for Martha Williams Brice, whose estate helped expand it. Today it holds about 80,000 fans.

NEXT HOME GAME

- **Sat Oct 24 vs Tennessee**. Kickoff window 3:30 to 4:30 PM.
- Oct 17 is a bye week. No game.
- Clear bag policy. Early gates open 2 hours before kickoff.

OFF-DAY OPTION

- Friday stadium tours are listed on the official Gamecocks game-day page. Book ahead.

Map | Tennessee tickets | Stadium tours

PLAN AHEAD

FALL CALENDAR

Dated events around the Midlands this fall. Tap any event for details and tickets.

Oct 15 to 25	**SC State Fair**	Rosewood Dr, Columbia
Oct 16 to 30	**Boo at the Zoo**	Riverbanks Zoo, 6 to 9 PM
Oct 18	**Woofstock**	Lexington. Music, food trucks, treats for the pups. Benefits the Humane Society of SC.
Oct 23	**Arts and Draughts**	Columbia Museum of Art after-hours party. 18+.
Oct 23 to 24	**Blythewood Fall Championship Rodeo**	Eight rodeo events, parade, food vendors
Oct 24	**Gamecocks vs Tennessee**	Williams-Brice Stadium
Oct 24	**Nightmare in Elmwood 5K**	Costume 5K and kids fun run, Elmwood Park
Oct 31	**SC Korean Festival**	Columbia. Korean barbecue, K-pop dance contest, performances.
Through Nov 8	**Corn maze and pumpkin patch**	Clinton Sease Farm, Lexington

Dates from each event's listing as of Oct 15, 2026. Confirm on the event page before you go.



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LIKE YOUR WEEKENDS HERE? LIVE CLOSER TO THEM.

Tell me how you spend a Saturday. I'll show you the neighborhoods that fit. Lexington, Irmo, Lake Murray, West Columbia, Northeast Columbia and everywhere in between.

NEXT STEP

Two minutes. Tell me what you're looking for.

Start here